

AICTE Doctoral Fellowship (ADF) scheme

Q. 1	What is AICTE Doctoral Fellowship (ADF) scheme?
Ans:	AICTE Doctoral Fellowship (ADF) scheme for Ph.D. students admitted in the AICTE approved Institution in full time/regular mode.
Q.2	Who is eligible for AICTE Doctoral fellowship (ADF)?
Ans:	i) The Candidate must be admitted to Ph.D. in any of “Engineering and Technology/ Management/ Design /Planning/ Applied Arts, Crafts and Design/ Computer Application” department approved by the AICTE to Post Graduate Level. Note: The candidate must have completed UG program of Hotel management & Catering technology approved by AICTE and Master Degree in relevant/ allied area. ii) The candidate must have successfully completed the Under Graduate or Post Graduate Degree (or Five Year Integrated/ Dual Degree leading to Postgraduate Degree) in “Engineering and Technology/ Management/ Design/ Planning/ Applied Arts, Crafts and Design/ Hotel Management and Catering Technology/ Computer Application” as per the condition prescribed by the admitted university. iii) Applied Science Post Graduate candidates willing to admit/admitted in Ph.D. in AICTE approved Institution are also eligible. iv) Candidate should have qualified national level examination (GATE/GMAT/CAT/CMAT/CEED/NET/JRF/SRF in last 5 five years
Q.3	What is the maximum age criteria of ADF scheme?
	The candidate should be below 30 years of age at the time of registration in ADF Scheme along with NOC from the university in case candidate is applying directly (category A). Or At the time of submission of application form for admission in university/ institute in case of (category B). Age relaxation of 5 years would be applicable to students belonging to SC/ST/Women/Physically challenged and 3 years for OBC category.
Q.4	What is the duration of the fellowship?
Ans:	The duration of the Fellowship shall be of maximum 5 Years (60 months) and will have periodic reviews for continuation/ upgradation.
Q.5	Any provision for extension of duration after 5 years.
Ans:	No extension for ADF is granted.
Q.6	Is there any reservation policy?
Ans:	The university/institute will follow the reservation policy of the Government of India issued from time to time. At present the reservation policy is as under: SC : 15% ST : 7.5% OBC : 27% General {including EWS (Max. 10%)} : 50.5%

Q.7	What is the amount of fellowship?
Ans:	The amount of fellowship will be Rs. 37,000/- per month for JRF followed by Rs. 42,000/- per month for SRF. HRA as per Government of India norms
Q.8	Is any contingency grant admissible?
Ans:	Contingency of Rs. 15,000/- per annum.
Q.9	What is last date for apply?
Ans:	The candidates are allowing to apply for ADF throughout the year after completion of admission process in the academic year. The process of uploading the detailed information of the admitted students must be completed on the AICTE portal within two months of date of admission. The date of start of ADF shall be the date of start of course work subject to uploading on the AICTE portal in time. Universities will admit candidates in their research programme as per their procedure following minimum eligibility criteria as prescribed by AICTE.
Q.10	Is a student who has qualified 5 years integrated dual degree B.Tech/ M.Tech program are eligible for admission as Ph.D. scholar under the scheme of ADF.
Ans:	The candidate must have successfully completed the Under Graduate or Post Graduate Degree (or Five Year Integrated/ Dual Degree leading to Postgraduate Degree) in "Engineering and Technology/ Management/ Design/ Planning/ Applied Arts, Crafts and Design/ Hotel Management and Catering Technology/ Computer Application" as per the condition prescribed by the admitted university.
Q.11	Whether work experience is counted in terms of eligibility for applying for Ph.D. Admissions under ADF scheme?
Ans:	Work experience is not a criterion for selection under ADF scheme.
Q.12	If a candidate gets selected in more than one Institute or in more than one department, does the candidate have the choice to choose the department after selection?
Ans:	Any such choice is not provided to the candidate after the selection.
Q.13	Whether fellowship is available for taking admission for the 2nd time in any other University/Institutes.
Ans:	AICTE supported ADF fellowship is not admissible to left out students, who have already availed the ADF fellowship from AICTE, on his/her taking admission for the 2nd time in any other University/Institutes.
Q.14	Is any TA/DA admissible for attending the interview for selection etc.?
Ans:	There is no provision for TA/DA for attending the interview.
Q.15	What is the Maximum Nos. of fellowship and Nos. of Universities'.

Ans:	All eligible Ph.D. students admitted in the AICTE approved Institution in full time/regular mode.
Q.16	Is there any time limit for registration
Ans:	(a) Non-completion of course-work and non-submission of approved research plan proposal as per university/ institute norms within 24 months. Note: In the cases where the fellowship has been discontinued as per clause (a), the fellowship may be resumed within 36 months after the successful completion of the course-work and approval of research plan/ proposal by the University/Institute.
Q.17	Is there any condition for cancellation of fellowship?
Ans:	The fellowship will be cancelled due to any of the reason given below: (a) Cancellation of admission by the university/ institute. (b) Misconduct by the student. (c) False information/ documents submitted by the student or indulged in any fraudulent activity. (d) Student found "Not-Eligible" for fellowship at any later stage. (h) The university/ institute will have assigned Teaching Assistantship to ADF students of 6 to 8 hours per week, by the Supervisor(s)/ Head of the Department based on the recommendation of his/ her supervisor(s) during the entire tenure of fellowship with effect from the date of start of ADF. The assistantship may include assistance in tutorial and lab classes; establishment, operation and maintenance of laboratories; invigilation during examinations; evaluation of answer sheets; etc. No independent teaching load can be assigned to the student, as a substitute for any regular teacher.
Q.18	Is there any restriction for taking part-time /full time assignments during the Ph.D. course?
Ans:	The student shall devote full-time to research during the tenure of fellowship and will not be permitted to take any part-time/ full-time assignment. He/ she will not accept any salary, fellowship or any type of financial assistance during the tenure of fellowship through any other source. In case student receives any financial assistance from any other organization during the tenure of fellowship, with due permission of the university/ institute, he/ she will not be entitled for the fellowship for the duration in which he/ she is availing such financial assistance and it shall be resumed on discontinuance of such external financial assistance. Further the period for which the scholar has received external financial assistance shall be deducted from the maximum duration of the fellowship i.e. 5 years.
Q.19	What is the method for payment of fellowship etc.?
Ans:	AICTE online portal will have mechanism for the purpose of releasing fellowship/ HRA/ contingency etc. amount directly in the Aadhaar seeded bank account of the beneficiary through DBT mode.
Q.20	Is there is any provision for medical assistance?
Ans.	No separate/ fixed medical assistance is provided. However, the research scholar may avail the medical facilities available in the Institution/ University/ College.
Q.21	What are the types of leave entitlement during the course?
Ans.	The ADF students are eligible for leave for a maximum period of 30 days in a year, in addition to public holidays. They are not entitled to any other vacation. The period

	spent for attending Conferences, Short-term Training Programmes, Workshops/ Seminars and any other outstation research work with the prior permission of his/ her supervisor will be treated as “on Duty”; this however, should not exceed 30 days in a year. • The ADF students are also eligible for maternity/ paternity leave as per GOI norms. Note: • All kinds of leave and “On Duty” period should be approved at the level of the institute on the recommendation of his/ her supervisor and proper record shall be maintained. • Here “Year” starts with the date of start of ADF.
Q.22	What are the condition or Teaching Work Load during the course?
Ans.	The university/ institute will have assigned Teaching Assistantship to ADF students of 6 to 8 hours per week, by the Supervisor(s)/ Head of the Department based on the recommendation of his/ her supervisor(s) during the entire tenure of fellowship with effect from the date of start of ADF. The assistantship may include assistance in tutorial and lab classes; establishment, operation and maintenance of laboratories; invigilation during examinations; evaluation of answer sheets; etc. No independent teaching load can be assigned to the student, as a substitute for any regular teacher.
Q.23	What happens if one left the course in midway?
Ans.	For those scholars who left the course midway, the further fellowship will be stopped.
Q.24	What happens if the fellow avails the break during the fellowship?
	In case student avails break during the tenure of the fellowship on medical ground with due permission of the institute, the fellowship will be discontinued from the date of start of break and shall be resumed on re-joining the program for the remaining period of fellowship.
For any other question may refer to the ADF Scheme guidelines available in AICTE website www.aicte-india.org/ https://fellowship.aicte.gov.in or emailed at : adf@aicte-india.org or contact helpline 01129581149	